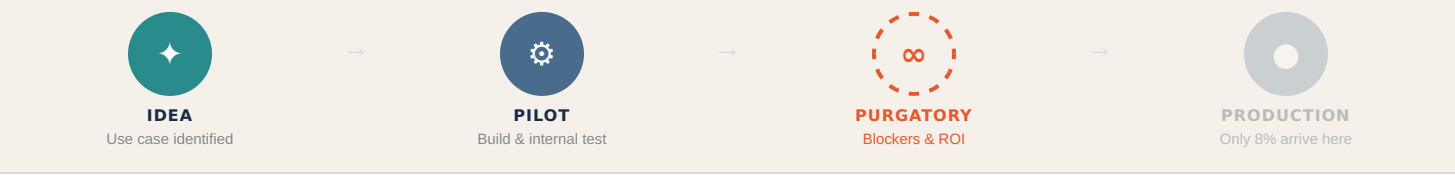


THE PILOT PURGATORY.

Four structural reasons why AI projects never make it out of the pilot phase and into real production.

TYPICAL JOURNEY OF AN ENTERPRISE AI PROJECT



1 OVERVIEW

Most corporate AI projects launch with enthusiasm and die in the pilot. **Only 8% of companies have any agent in production**, while the sector average accumulates 23 disconnected tools per company. The bottleneck is not the technology — it is four recurring structural failures that trap the project before it generates real value.

2 THE FOUR CAUSES OF PURGATORY

1

PLUG-AND-PLAY ILLUSION
Companies believe AI tools work without process redesign. In practice, every autonomous agent requires journey re-engineering and active sponsors.

2

PILOT COST ≠ PRODUCTION COST
Token costs in a pilot are calculated on a controlled set of activities. In production, edge cases and larger volumes emerge — the real cost only appears when it is too late to replan.

3

IT WITHOUT BUSINESS
Projects built solely by technology ignore the end user. After months of build, the commercial team looks and says "this is not what I wanted." Business must co-create from day zero.

4

NO KPI, NO SUSTAIN
Projects without measurable business metrics lose political traction. Without a KPI that moves when the agent goes live, the project is silently discontinued.

3 WARNING SIGNS — WHERE THE FLOW STALLS

▲

Undocumented process
The real process differs from what is in Miro. Nobody mapped what actually happens day to day.

▲

Shadow AI proliferating
45% of tools adopted without IT. Business teams build prototypes that reach production without security review.

▲

No ROI after 3 months
56% of CEOs report zero result. Without visible return, the project loses executive priority.

4 METRICS THAT SEPARATE PILOT FROM PRODUCTION

DIMENSION	BUSINESS METRIC	TECHNOLOGY METRIC
Efficiency	Time reduction per task (%)	Average response latency (ms)
Cost	Cost per automated transaction	Tokens consumed per session
Quality	Error rate that falls back to human	Eval score / hallucination rate
Scale	Volume processed vs. monthly target	Throughput under peak load

5 HOW PURGATORY VARIES BY CONTEXT

LARGE ENTERPRISE (500+)
Purgatory is political — compliance, ISO, GDPR approvals. Solution: quick win in an isolated area to set a precedent.

MID-SIZE COMPANY (50-500)
Purgatory is about process — missing documentation and a single sponsor. Solution: consultancy alongside the build.

STARTUP / BUILDER
Purgatory is focus — passion for tech replaces user validation. Solution: sell before you build.

95%

of AI projects fail (MIT)

8%

of companies have an agent in production

56%

of CEOs report no AI result (PWC)

23

AI tools per company on average

45%

of adoptions happen outside IT

The only certainty you can have is that you will make mistakes on the way from pilot to production. **The question is not how to avoid the mistake — it is having metrics to catch it fast.**